



KYLE CRAICHY / AI FOR OPERATORS

# KEEP BUILDING FROM YOUR PHONE

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Claude Code has a Remote Control mode. Start a build at your desk, walk away, and keep steering it from your phone — while your computer does all the actual work.

**THE 5-MINUTE SETUP**

WHAT IT ACTUALLY IS

# YOUR LAPTOP DOES THE WORK. YOU JUST STEER.

Remote Control opens a live window into a Claude Code session running on your own machine. Your computer stays the engine — your files, your terminal, your tools never leave it. Your phone just becomes another way to talk to it.

## WHAT STAYS ON YOUR COMPUTER

Your files, your terminal, your project setup, and every command that actually runs. Nothing executes on your phone.

## WHAT YOUR PHONE GETS

A live, two-way view of the conversation. Type from your laptop, your phone, or a browser — it all syncs.

## BEFORE YOU START — THE CHECKLIST

- **A paid Claude plan.** Pro, Max, Team, or Enterprise. API keys do *not* work for this.
- **Signed in with your Claude account** — run `claude /login`, not an API key.
- **Open the project once on your computer** and accept the trust prompt.
- **Your computer stays awake and online.** It's doing the work — if it sleeps, the session ends.
- On a **Team or Enterprise** plan, an owner has to switch Remote Control on in admin settings first.

# TURN IT ON THREE WAYS

Pick whichever fits what you're doing. All three end up in the same place — a session you can open on your phone.

1

## ALREADY WORKING? JUST FLIP IT ON.

In a session that's already running, type this. Naming it makes it easy to spot on your phone later.

```
/remote-control My Project  
shortcut: /rc My Project
```

2

## STARTING FRESH? LAUNCH WITH IT.

Opens a normal session you can still type into locally — just remote-ready from the jump.

```
claude --remote-control "My Project"
```

3

## GOING FULLY MOBILE? SERVER MODE.

Runs in the background waiting for you. Once it's up, tap **spacebar** to pop a QR code on screen.

```
claude remote-control
```

## Now grab it on your phone

**Scan the QR code** from server mode · **or** copy the session URL it prints and open it anywhere · **or** open the Claude app (or [claude.ai/code](https://claude.ai/code)), go to the **Code** tab, and tap your session — a green dot means it's live.

# WHAT YOU CAN DO FROM THE COUCH

The phone is a real working surface, not just a viewer. A few things stay tied to your keyboard, though — worth knowing before you rely on it.

## WORKS FROM YOUR PHONE

- Send messages and keep the build moving
- Watch progress on long jobs and subagents
- Upload a photo or file straight from your camera roll
- Switch models with `/model`
- Housekeeping: `/clear`, `/compact`, `/context`, `/usage`
- Rename the session with `/rename`

## STAYS ON YOUR COMPUTER

- Anything with a picker — file browsers, menus
- `/plugin` — local only
- `/resume` — local only
- The session itself: if the computer sleeps or you close the terminal, it's over

## THE MOVE THAT MAKES THIS WORTH IT

Kick off something slow before you leave — a big refactor, a batch job, a research run. Let it grind while you drive, eat, or sit in a waiting room. Check in from your phone, answer the one question it has, and keep it going. You reclaim the dead time without being chained to the desk.

**Heads up:** whether you can approve permission prompts from your phone isn't clearly spelled out in the docs yet. Assume anything needing a hard approval may still want you at the keyboard — plan the long-running, low-approval work for mobile.

DON'T GET CAUGHT OUT

# THE FINE PRINT

Five things that'll save you a confused ten minutes.

## YOUR COMPUTER HAS TO STAY AWAKE

This is the one that gets everyone. Remote Control is a window into a live local process — it is not the cloud. Sleep the laptop and the session dies. Turn off auto-sleep before you walk away.

## LOSE WI-FI FOR ~10 MINUTES AND IT DROPS

Short blips reconnect on their own. A long outage ends the process — just start it again with `claude remote-control`.

## ONE REMOTE CONNECTION PER SESSION

In normal interactive mode you get one remote device at a time. Server mode is the one that handles more.

## YOUR CONVERSATION SYNCs THROUGH ANTHROPIC

While Remote Control is connected, the transcript lives on Anthropic's servers so your devices stay in sync. Your files and commands still never leave your machine. Organizations on zero-data-retention can't use this feature.

## NOTHING IS EXPOSED TO THE INTERNET

No open ports, no tunnel into your machine — it's an outbound encrypted connection, same as any normal Claude Code session.

## Now go use it

Start one session today with `/rc` and check it from your phone once. That's the whole habit — the rest takes care of itself. Official docs: [code.claude.com/docs/en/remote-control](https://code.claude.com/docs/en/remote-control)

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